He misunderstood their income, the bank said no, and there was no fix. Don't let this happen to you. Read the full story. View in browser

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Fall Market Crossroads: Buy Now or Wait It Out?

Condo prices are sliding, listings are piling up, and the sidelines are crowded with buyers waiting for the next rate cut.

So, is this the calm before the storm, or the moment to make your move?

In this month's newsletter, we're unpacking the key shifts we are seeing on the ground, from stalled condo sales in Toronto **to a cautionary tale about how one bank adviser's mistake cost a young couple their dream mortgage** and lastly, what to watch as the Bank of Canada prepares for its next rate decision on October 29th.

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Let's take a closer look at what's moving and what's not, so you can make informed decisions this fall.

GET IN TOUCH

🏢 Should You Buy a Toronto Condo Now, or Wait?

Toronto's condo market is hurting.

Sales are down, listings are stacking up, and **prices have dropped nearly 20% from their peak.** But does that mean it's time to jump in, or sit tight?

I've broken down the chaos and looked at where the smart money might go next. If you're a buyer, renter, or investor, here's what you need to know.

What's really going on, and where opportunity might be hiding

- **Condo prices are down** nearly 19% from the 2022 peak, and sales are a whopping 90% below the 10-year average.

- **Power-of-sale listings are climbing,** which is never a good sign, but it can mean deals for brave buyers.

- **Some first-time buyers are still holding back**, not because they can't, but because they're betting the market hasn't hit bottom.

  With more listings on the way and rates likely to drop, many are choosing to wait, save, and strengthen their down payments.

- **Preconstruction isn't the same gamble it was in the '90s.** Most projects today need 70% of units sold before a shovel hits the ground. Our advice is to avoid pre-construction units.

- **If you're buying now**, aim for larger units in good locations, strong reserve funds, and reasonable maintenance fees. **Avoid micro-**

condos; they were a hard sell even in a hot market.

The bottom line? There are smart moves to make, even in a falling market.

Read my full breakdown ⟶ [Should You Buy a Toronto Condo Now or Wait Until 2026]

HAVE A QUESTION?

🏠 Why You Shouldn't Always Trust a Bank Adviser With Your Mortgage

One misstep. That's all it took for a well-qualified young couple to lose access to a top-rate mortgage, **and there was no way to fix it after the fact.**

In my Canadian Mortgage Trends article, I tell this story: it's a cautionary tale about how relying on the wrong person at the wrong time can close the door on your deal.

Here's what went wrong and what you can learn from it:

- **A local branch adviser offered to handle the couple's mortgage** after helping them access their FHSA (First Home Savings Account). He told them there was no need to return to us.
- **He submitted the file, then it got declined.** Even after escalating, the bank said no twice.
- **His mistake? Misinterpreting their income.** Their pay stubs were tricky, but the numbers were there—he just didn't know how to present them properly.
- **Once declined at the bank level, their policy blocked any chance of resubmitting,** even though I knew how to fix it.
- **This isn't about one bad bank.** It's about understanding that branch staff are generalists. Mortgages aren't always their specialty, and that matters.

The moral of the story?

If your income isn't 100% straightforward, think twice about handing your mortgage file to someone who *"dabbles in mortgages"*. **Work with a professional.**

Read my article at Canadian Mortgage Trends ⟶ [Opinion: Borrowers should think twice before handing their mortgage to a bank adviser].

GET IN TOUCH

📉 All Eyes on October 29: Will Rates Drop Again?

The Bank of Canada's next rate decision is set for October 29th, and with Trump's recent announcement that trade talks with Canada are over, markets are leaning toward another 0.25% cut.

What this could mean for you:

- A cut would lower the policy rate to **2.25%**, easing pressure for **mortgage renewals** and **variable-rate borrowers**
- **60% of mortgages** are up for renewal in the next two years, and any relief matters.
- If you're weighing **fixed vs. variable**, it looks like we are in for a rate cut

on October 29th, with at least one more cut to follow by the end of the year.

- After that, most economists feel that the **end of this rate-cutting cycle may be near.**

Whatever happens, this decision could ripple through your next mortgage move. Read some of our predictions from our last Bank of Canada article.

As always, if you have any questions, my team and I are here to help. You can email us at info@askross.ca or call us at 416-989-1000.

All the best, and talk soon,

Ross Taylor

📚 Essential Home Buying Guides

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